

TELCONG NETPLAN

Network Planning & Regulatory Affairs

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NCC Hearing Transcripts Archive

Prior public hearings, Spectrum Management Department, 2024-2026

Compiled by	Fatima Musa, Regulatory Liaison
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Transcripts included	4 prior NCC spectrum hearings
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#	Date	Hearing	Presenter	Outcome
T1	2024-04-12	MTN spectrum reallocation, 2600 MHz	MTN Nigeria, N. Chidi	Granted with conditions
T2	2025-03-21	Airtel coverage extension, 900 MHz	Airtel Nigeria, A. Bello	Granted
T3	2025-11-18	9mobile 5G pilot, 3700-3800 MHz	9mobile, K. Folarin	Granted with conditions
T4	2026-05-09	Globacom site density, 1800 MHz	Globacom, E. Achebe	Granted

All four hearings were presided over by Commissioner Dr. Aminu Garba. Dr. Yusuf Ibrahim, Senior Spectrum Officer at the NCC, is named in transcripts T1 and T3 as the case officer who handled the post-hearing clarification process.

T1, MTN spectrum reallocation, 2600 MHz (2024-04-12)

Hearing convened by Commissioner Dr. Aminu Garba at NCC HQ, Mboras Crescent, Abuja. Applicant: MTN Nigeria Communications PLC. Presenter: N. Chidi, Senior Manager Spectrum Strategy. Reallocation requested: 30 MHz of the 2600 MHz band (paired FDD) for LTE-A capacity expansion in Lagos and Port Harcourt.

Commissioner Garba: Mr. Chidi, the 2600 MHz allocation you currently hold expires next April. Why is this application coming forward now rather than at renewal?

Mr. Chidi: Sir, we are requesting a 30 MHz expansion on top of the renewal. The expansion is what triggers the new application track per Section 121 of the Act. Renewal is handled through the standard licence-renewal process.

Commissioner Garba: Understood. Walk me through the capacity justification for the 30 MHz expansion.

Mr. Chidi: We have measured RAN congestion on the LTE-A grid in seven LGAs in Lagos. Average busy-hour PRB utilisation has crossed 78% in those cells. Industry practice triggers densification or spectrum expansion above 70%. We have run both scenarios and the spectrum expansion is more cost-effective per MB of additional capacity, in addition to being faster to market.

Commissioner Garba: Dr. Ibrahim, anything from your technical team on the coordination analysis?

Dr. Ibrahim: Mr. Commissioner, we have reviewed the coordination analysis at Annex D-3. The applicant has identified six adjacent assignments. Two of those, both held by 9mobile, will require coordination. The applicant has indicated they are in discussions with 9mobile already. We would recommend the assignment be made conditional on those coordination discussions reaching written agreement within 90 days of grant.

Commissioner Garba: Noted. Mr. Chidi, any objection to that condition?

Mr. Chidi: No objection, sir. We will document the agreements and provide copies to the Commission within the 90 days.

Commissioner Garba: Anything from the local content side, Mrs. Adeniyi?

Mrs. Adeniyi: The local content commitment in Section E shows 100% on civil works, 95% on installation, but only 18% on equipment supply. The Commission would like to see a path to improving the equipment supply percentage over the term of the assignment.

Mr. Chidi: Acknowledged, sir. We can commit to a 25% target by year three and 35% by year five, contingent on the maturity of the local OEM ecosystem in the 2600 MHz band.

Commissioner Garba: Acceptable. We will include those targets as conditions of grant. Determination will issue within 30 days. Thank you, Mr. Chidi. Hearing adjourned.

T2, Airtel coverage extension, 900 MHz (2025-03-21)

Hearing convened by Commissioner Dr. Aminu Garba. Applicant: Airtel Networks Limited. Presenter: A. Bello, Head of Spectrum Engineering. Coverage extension requested: 5 MHz additional in the 900 MHz band for rural coverage in Sokoto, Zamfara, and Kebbi States.

Commissioner Garba: Mr. Bello, the 900 MHz band is heavily used. Walk me through your incumbent coordination.

Mr. Bello: Sir, we have identified the incumbent 900 MHz assignments in our coordination analysis at Annex D-3. The 5 MHz we are requesting is currently vacant in the three target states because the previous assignee, GSM Nigeria Limited, surrendered it in 2023.

Commissioner Garba: Right, I recall the surrender. Why hasn't it been reassigned in the two intervening years?

Mr. Bello: It was offered in the 2024 spectrum auction, sir, but received no bids. The Commission held a follow-up consultation in October 2024 and concluded that targeted assignment to a serious rural-coverage applicant would be the better path. That is what we are presenting today.

Commissioner Garba: Dr. Ibrahim, your team's view on the rural coverage commitment?

Dr. Ibrahim: Mr. Commissioner, the applicant has committed to 240 new cell sites across the three states over 36 months, with first-site live within 9 months. Independent verification of cell-site count is included in the Section C response. The commitment is at the upper end of what we have seen for rural coverage applications.

Commissioner Garba: Any objections from the floor?

Member of public, Mr. Tijani Sani: Sir, my community in Zamfara has been waiting for mobile coverage for nine years. We are 18 kilometres from the nearest cell tower. I would like an assurance that the 240 sites will include the underserved LGAs and not concentrate on the urban centres of those three states.

Mr. Bello: Mr. Sani, the LGA list is at Annex C-2 of our submission. I can confirm Bukkuyum, Maradun, and Gummi LGAs are included with 12, 8, and 14 sites respectively. I have copies of Annex C-2 if you would like to review them after the hearing.

Commissioner Garba: Thank you, Mr. Sani, for raising the question. The Commission will reflect the LGA breakdown in the conditions of grant. Hearing adjourned. Determination within 30 days.

T3, 9mobile 5G pilot, 3700-3800 MHz (2025-11-18)

Hearing convened by Commissioner Dr. Aminu Garba. Applicant: 9mobile Telecommunications. Presenter: K. Folarin, Director of Spectrum Strategy. Pilot assignment requested: 100 MHz in the 3700-3800 MHz upper portion of the 3.5 GHz band for 5G NR pilot deployment in Lagos Mainland and Victoria Island.

Commissioner Garba: Mr. Folarin, the 3.5 GHz band is the most-requested resource in our 2025-2026 pipeline. What makes the case for assigning 100 MHz to a pilot deployment?

Mr. Folarin: Sir, the pilot is a 18-month commitment to deploy 60 sites in Lagos. The 100 MHz allows a meaningful demonstration of mid-band 5G capacity. A smaller assignment would not allow us to measure the densification benefit the technology is designed to deliver.

Commissioner Garba: And after 18 months?

Mr. Folarin: We commit to submitting a full commercial application within 12 months of pilot launch, supported by the pilot measurement data. If the commercial application is not approved or not

submitted, we surrender the 100 MHz back to the Commission for reassignment.

Commissioner Garba: Dr. Ibrahim, any concerns?

Dr. Ibrahim: Mr. Commissioner, we welcome the pilot. The 3700-3800 MHz portion is less encumbered than the 3500-3600 MHz lower portion, which makes it well suited to the pilot. We would recommend the assignment be made conditional on quarterly measurement reports being filed with the Commission, beginning at month 3.

Commissioner Garba: Mr. Folarin, the quarterly reports?

Mr. Folarin: Accepted, sir. We will commit to quarterly reports as a condition of grant.

Commissioner Garba: Local content?

Mr. Folarin: Civil works 100%, installation 90%, equipment supply 14%. The 14% reflects the current 5G NR OEM market, only Ericsson, Nokia, and Huawei have certified mid-band radios in Nigeria today, and none of them manufacture locally. We expect the percentage to improve as the market matures.

Commissioner Garba: Noted. Hearing adjourned. Determination within 30 days.

T4, Globacom site density, 1800 MHz (2026-05-09)

Hearing convened by Commissioner Dr. Aminu Garba. Applicant: Globacom Limited. Presenter: E. Achebe, GM Spectrum Engineering. Site density expansion requested: 800 new cell sites across 6 states, leveraging existing 1800 MHz assignment.

Commissioner Garba: Mr. Achebe, this is not a spectrum assignment application. Why is it before the Commission as a public hearing?

Mr. Achebe: Sir, the volume of the densification triggers a notification requirement under our existing assignment conditions. We are formally notifying the Commission of the 800-site deployment and inviting any conditions the Commission wishes to attach to ensure compliance with EMF and coordination requirements at the densified locations.

Commissioner Garba: Understood. EMF compliance at the densified sites?

Mr. Achebe: All 800 sites will be measured against the ICNIRP 1998 guidelines as adopted in NCC technical standards. Independent measurement reports will be filed within 90 days of each site going live. We have committed to a third-party measurement firm, certified by the Commission's approved list.

Commissioner Garba: Site approval process at the LGA level?

Mr. Achebe: All 800 sites have either secured LGA permits or are at advanced stages of community engagement. We have been working with TelcoNG NetPlan and MTN's site-acquisition teams on best-practice templates for community objection handling, which we believe has streamlined the LGA approval process for the industry as a whole.

Commissioner Garba: Good. Hearing adjourned, no conditions added beyond the standard EMF reporting commitment. Determination not required, this was a notification hearing.

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